

ENGR 95 Reflection #1- Meghan Tennant

Growing up, I've always been interested in engineering; taking things apart, rebuilding them, and figuring out how they work. I love combining my imaginative side with my analytical side, combining creative thinking and art with science and math. I enjoy puzzles and problem-solving, especially in real-life situations. Math has always been my favorite subject, so I started taking computer science and engineering classes, which incorporated similar logical thinking principles. The field of Civil Engineering stood out to me because I liked the idea of building infrastructure that can positively affect thousands of people. I came to Lehigh because I knew they had an incredible engineering program and a beautiful campus. When I visited campus, my tour was extremely informative and in-depth, showcasing Lehigh's impressive research labs and Wilbur Powerhouse, as well as providing interactions with professors and university staff.

To me, Engineering Mindset is a way of thinking that all engineers should adapt when solving real-world problems, choosing to use a systematic and iterative design process. It relies on applying math and science and, rather than searching for a single answer, continuing to experiment and collaborate with others to make a meaningful impact. Three things I will do in my first year to develop an Engineering Mindset are working in teams, persisting and learning from failure, and exploring materials. In my ENGR 95 lab, I am already beginning to incorporate these goals, learning about Material Science Engineering and building a sensor in small groups, making mistakes but learning from them.